Term Paper: Guidelines and Questions

GFH 1000 | CUHK, 2024-25, 1st |Deng Yangzhou| dengyangzhou@cuhk.edu.cn|

A) GUIDELINES

1)Format:

Paper size: A4 | Font: Times New Roman / 新细明体, or 宋体, 12| Spacing: 1.5 lines |Front Page: type your name, student ID, tutorial group name | Word count: 1400-1800 words in English or 1800-2400 characters in Chinese |Include a word count in parentheses at the end of the paper

2) Submission

Submit your paper in Word format via your course Moodle. Use the following name as your file name, replacing the "Student ID" with your own real ID number: "**TP-Student ID.doc**".

The submission deadline is to be confirmed later.

For late submission, 5 marks (out of 100) will be deducted with each day of delay.

3）Consultation

See BB's appointment online form, or you could send a term paper outline to the instruction for advices.

4) Making Criteria

Thinking and Reasoning (including understanding of the text) (70%)

Awareness of *contexts* — Are you aware of the context of the question and are you able to assess its implications?

Handling *complexity* — Are you able to perceive the scope and complexity of the problems you address? Do you approach the problem from multiple perspectives?

Demonstration of *autonomy* — Can you introduce issues and perspectives that give a different shape to the problems being discussed?

Use of *quotations* — Are you able to choose suitable quotations to support your arguments? Do you show a reasonable understanding of the text?

Language and Presentation (30%)

Have you demonstrated adequate use of *grammar*, *punctuation* and other *conventions* of formal writing?
Have you made an informed *choice of words*?
Does your writing demonstrate a clear *structure* (introduction, elaboration, conclusion)?
Have you clearly indicated where you use other people's views, observations or words, and properly stated their sources in *parenthetical notes (or footnotes)* and a list of *references*?

B) QUESTIONS

Choose **one** of the four questions below, and write your essay. Or think of a **new** topic, and get the endorsement of your course instructor before you write.

以下五条问题，选择一条作答。或自拟一题，获教师许可后撰文。

1) Freedom and Humanity

Freedom is arguably the unique characteristic distinguishing humanity from the life of animals or instruments, and for many classic thinkers to pursue good life is to seek after freedom. Various kinds of freedom have been discussed in the textbook, some of them are spiritual, and some material, and still some institutional. Find two of the texts which deal with freedom in the same category, and analyze their differences and similarities. Feel free to lay out your own judgments of their thoughts.

自由与人性 人与动物或者其他机械存在的最独特的区别也许就是自由。对很多经典思想家而言，追求美好人生，就是追求自由。本课中的作者们讨论了各种自由，有的是精神性的，有的是物质性的或者制度性的。选择其中两家有共同话题的文本，分析它们关于自由的思想的异同点，并且做出你的评价。

2) Comparative Analysis on Concepts of Love Love or benevolence, the disposition to treat others well, is one of the most intriguing topics in studying humanity. Quite a few writers in the textbook, eg. Plato, Aristotle, Authors of the Gospel of *Mark*, and Confucius, address this topic from various perspectives. You may choose two or three of the writers, and analyze their different understandings of love, and put forward your theoretic understanding of it inspired by them.

比较视野中的爱 爱人，是人性讨论中的一个重要话题。本科目教材中，亦有多个思想家深入地讨论了爱的话题，譬如孔子的仁爱、基督的圣爱、亚里士多德的友爱甚至柏拉图的灵肉之爱。试选择其中两或三家思想，比较其异同，并表达你自己对此问题的看法。题目自拟。

3) Ideal Society

Directly or indirectly, various writers of the selected texts talk about ideal society, or on the other note, miserable society, including Confucius, Zhuangzi, Huang Zongxi, Roussea, Smith and Marx. Choose two of them, and compare their thoughts in relevant ways, and write a paper on ideal or bad society. Give a title to your paper by yourself.

If you wish, you could also write an imaginary dialogue between the two authors.

理想社会 孔子、斯密、马克思、卢梭、黄宗羲等人，在选文中都直接或者间接谈到了心目中的理想社会或者批评了他们心目中的不理想社会。选择其中两家思想，做一个有针对性的比较，以理想社会或者非理想社会为核心话题撰写一篇论文，自拟题目。

作者亦可以将文章以对话体的方式布局。

4) What Humanity Is

Humanity, or human nature, means the unique characteristics that distinguishes human race from other species or . Various classic thinkers have expressed their understandings of humanity, such as rationality, moral sentiment. Write an article based on two or three texts from the course. Compare how these thinkers/texts understand human nature, and give your own understanding. Give your article a title.

人性是什么 所谓人性，即人之为人、人之区别于其他物类的特性。此话题历来为哲学家们所思索，并有不同的答案。有人认为人性的核心乃是理性，而有人则认为是道德情操。试分析课本选文中两至三家思想对此问题的理解，并尝试一自主的理解。自定义题目。

Appendix : Citation Style

When writing an academic essay, you may want to clarify or support your argument with quotations from the original text. You can do so by using *direct* or *indirect* quotations. To make a direct quotation, you use a phrase or

sentence exactly as it appears in the original text, enclosing it in quotation marks. If the direct quotation runs for more than three lines, you may set it off as an indented paragraph. To make an *indirect* quotation, you present the phrase(s) or sentence(s) in your own words in the form of a paraphrase or a summary.

Whether you are making a *direct* or *indirect* quotation, you must indicate clearly that you are borrowing someone else's idea, not offering your own. You must also state your source clearly by doing two things.

First, immediately following the quotation, you should insert a parenthetical note giving (1) the name of the author of the book from which you are quoting (or the name of the book if the author is unknown) and (2) the page number of the book in which you find the original text. For example,

> *The Social Contract* opens with an intriguing statement: "Man is born free; and everywhere he is in chains" (Rousseau 384). What kind of "chains" does the author mean? What "chains" do we face today and how do we break free from them? This is what we aim to examine in this essay.

Second, at the end of the essay, you should include a "Work(s) Cited" and provide full information of the publication from which you find the quotation. You should list the author's name, the book title, (the translator's name), the city of publication, the name of publisher, and the year of publication, as below:

Work Cited
Jean-Jacques Rousseau. 2007. *The Social Contract*. Tr. G.D.H. Cole. Miami: BN Publishing.

If it is through the textbook that you find access to *The Social Contract*, your "Work Cited" should read like this (remember to say which edition of the textbook you are using, as the pagination differs between the two editions):

Work Cited
Jean-Jacques Rousseau. 2007. *The Social Contract*. Tr. G.D.H. Cole. Miami: BN Publishing. In *In Dialogue with Humanity: Textbook for General Education Foundation Programme*. 2013, 3rd ed. Hong Kong: Office of University General Education, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 383-421.

Several classics of our syllabus, however, have established conventions for academic citations and require you to give the relevant book number, chapter number, or line number. It is not advisable that you master the citation style unique to each of these classics, and the list of sample citations below will help. Below, two examples are provided for each of the twelve classics in the syllabus to show you how to document *indirect* and *direct* quotations properly.

1. *The Odyssey*

State the book number and line number(s) when making a quotation from *The Odyssey*. For instance, in e.g.(1) below, 23:184-186 means Book 23, Lines 184-186.

E.g.(1) Penelope tests her husband by telling her maid to bring the marital bed out from the bedroom (23:184-186).

E.g.(2) Odysseus makes his first appearance as a worn-out man: "She [Calypso] found him sitting where the breakers rolled in. His eyes were perpetually wet with tears now, His life draining away in homesickness." (5:150-152)

2. *Symposium*

State the line number when making a quotation from the *Symposium*, following the Stephanus Numbers (e.g., 215b-c, 223d, as appear below).

E.g.(1) Alcibiades praises Socrates with similes, comparing him to such mythical figures as Silenus and Marsyas (215b-c).

E.g.(2) The *Symposium* ends with Socrates leaving the party in sobriety: "He went to the Lyceum, had a bath, spent the rest of the day as he normally would, and then, towards evening, went home to bed" (223d).

3. *The Nicomachean Ethics*

State the line number when making a quotation from *The Nicomachean Ethics*, following the Bekker Numbers (e.g., 1157b8-14).

E.g.(1) Aristotle mentions that friendship will fade out after long separation (VIII 5, 1157b8-14).

E.g.(2) Aristotle emphasizes the importance of "living together": "those who approve of each other but do not spend all their time together seem to be well disposed rather than friendly, because nothing is so characteristic of friends as spending time together." (VIII 5, 1157b20 f.)

4. 《论语》*The Analects*

征引《论语》原文，请标明引文的标准编码。《论语》各篇章均已统一编号，例一所引之章句，标准编号为 13.18，表示章句出于《论语》第十三篇十八节。例二之 7.22，表示章句出于《论语》第七篇二十二节。

例（一）孔子认为儿子隐瞒父亲的过犯是直率的表现(13.18)。

例（二）孔子主张学习朋友的优点，看到朋友的缺点，则反省自己，加以改正：「子曰：『三人行，必有我师焉：择其善者而从之，其不善者而改之。』」(7.22)

5. 《庄子》

征引《庄子》原文时，请标明引文所出之篇名及课本页数（如〈逍遙遊〉，页 213）。为方便读者在原文查阅所引章句，可同时书明引所出之课本页数。

例（一）莊子以樗樹不符合繩墨，枝幹彎曲，反而免於砍伐，說明無用之用的道理（〈逍遙遊〉，頁 213）。

例（二）莊子認爲人與其「相濡以沫，不如相忘於江湖」（〈大宗師〉，頁 228）。

6. 〈般若之心〉

征引〈般若之心〉内容时，请标明课本页数。

例（一）一行禅师运用比喻说明「互即互入」的道理，例如从一张纸可以看出背后存在的云、雨、树木，甚至阳光、小麦、伐木工人等一切事物 (页 243-244)。

例（二）一行禅师指出，「在佛教中，知识被认为是般若的障碍」(页 245)。

7. 《圣经》

征引《圣经》章句，请标明章句所出之篇名及章节编号。

例（一）《圣经》把女性怀孕的痛苦解释为上帝的惩罚（〈创世记〉3:16）。

例（二）耶稣说：「谁遵行神的旨意，谁就是我的兄弟、姊妹和母亲了」（〈马可福音〉3:35），反映他的伦理观与一般人不同。

8. *Qur'an*

State the sura number and line number when making a quotation from the *Qur'an*.

E.g.(1) "O People! Worship your Lord who created you as well as those who came before you. Perhaps you will fear Him. (2:21)" In this verse, "people" refers to the people of Israel.

E.g.(2) The Qur'an provides detailed guidelines for divorce (2:226-232, 236-237).

9. 《明夷待访录》

征引《明夷待访录》原文时，请标明引文所出之篇名。

例（一）黄宗羲期望贤君采用他的治国方针，如同箕子获明君探访。（〈题辞〉）

例（二）黄宗羲以拉木头比喻君臣治理天下：「夫治天下犹曳大木然，前者唱邪，后者唱许。君与臣，共曳木之人也；若手不执绋，足不履地，曳木者唯娱笑于曳木者之前，从曳木者以为良，而曳木之职荒矣。」（〈原臣〉）他指出臣子若只顾取悦、娱乐君主，就荒废了治理天下的职责。

10. *The Social Contract*

State the book number, chapter number, and page number when making a quotation.

E.g.(1) According to Rousseau, family is the first model of political societies (Book I, Chapter II, p.385).

E.g.(2) Rousseau begins *The Social Contract* by claiming that "[m]an is born free; and everywhere he is in chains" (Book I, Chapter I, p.384). What kind of "chains" does he have in mind? This is what we aim to explore in this essay.

11. *The Wealth of Nations*

State the book number, chapter number, and page number when making a quotation.

E.g.(1) Adam Smith uses the production of pins as an example to illustrate the benefits of division of labour (Book I, Chapter I, p.424).

E.g.(2) Adam Smith expresses his view on human nature in *The Wealth of Nations*. He thinks that all human beings have "the propensity to truck, barter, and exchange one thing for another" (Book I, Chapter II, p.429).

12. "Wages of Labour" and "Estranged Labour"

State the chapter title and page number of the quotation in the textbook. The essay title can be embedded in your sentence or in the parenthetical note.

E.g.(1) Unlike Adam Smith, Karl Marx draws attention to the negative impact of division of labour, arguing that it leads workers to compete with each other and with the machines ("Wages of Labour," p.457).

E.g.(2) In the essay "Estranged Labour," Marx examines the relation between man's "species-being" and nature by first defining the "genuine human functions" (p.462).